Finance, Administration and Economic Development Committee Meeting

Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, March 16, 2026
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378118

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Lawson called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair Mark Lawson
Committee Vice-Chair Logan Cunningham
Committee Member Gerald Dawson - Virtual
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Joseph Passiment - Virtual
Committee Member Paula Brown
Council Member Anna Maria Tabernik - Virtual
Council Member Lawrence McElynn - Virtual

Absent
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Lawson stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Brown to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Brown to approve the minutes from February 17, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

6. Public Comment Period

No public comments were taken.

7. Reports

a. Finance Report **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/378118

8. Presentations and Discussion Items

a. Presentation of Options to fund USCB's Convocation Center **(FISCAL IMPACT: It will be dependent on which option the Council chooses.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham to open for discussion.

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member McElynn to move all four options to County Council with the recommendation of option number 4.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member McElynn.

Voting Nay: Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Brown, and Council Member Tabernik. The motion failed 4:4.

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9. Agenda Items

a. An ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $739,108.13 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury. **(FISCAL IMPACT: Funds are moving within the already obligated projects. No additional fiscal impact)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member McElynn to approve an ordinance to reallocate remaining American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) funds in the amount of $739,108.13 towards existing projects as obligated to the Department of Treasury.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

b. An ordinance to reallocate the funds from the 2025 Series GO Bond for Passive Parks projects. **(FISCAL IMPACT: There is no fiscal impact. The same dollar amount is going from two projects to four projects of $5,940,912.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO - Chief Financial Officer Stefanie Nagid- Land Preservation Director

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Dawson to approve an ordinance to reallocate the funds from the 2025 Series GO Bond for Passive Parks projects.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

c. An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the necessary documents and provide funding for the purchase of real property located at 641 Sea Island Parkway **(FISCAL IMPACT: The purchase price is $32,500, plus closing costs. Funding for this project is from the Capital Projects Fund (Fund 4000) – Land Acquisition (Account #4000-80-1000-54400). The current account balance is $1,854,891.82.)** - Jared Fralix, ACA (5 min)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Brown to approve an Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the necessary documents and provide funding for the purchase of real property located at 641 Sea Island Parkway.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

d. An ordinance to amend Ordinance 2023/26 to reallocate funds previously appropriated for Daufuskie Island Ferry embarkation points to Sun City Joint Fire/EMS Station (Station #39). **(FISCAL IMPACT: Funds will be transferred between projects. No additional fiscal impact.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve an ordinance to amend Ordinance 2023/26 to reallocate funds previously appropriated for Daufuskie Island Ferry embarkation points to Sun City Joint Fire/EMS Station (Station#39).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

e. Approval of a contract amendment to Fraser Construction for the construction portion of the Sun City Fire/EMS Station 39 ($5,348,446) **(FISCAL IMPACT: The fee for the construction portion of the project is $4,862,224. Staff recommends a 10% contingency of $486,222, bringing the total request to $5,348,446.**

The funding for this project will be from the 2017 GO Bond, account # 4010-80-0000-54420.) - Jared Fralix - Assistant County Administrator (5 min).

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Committee Member Passiment to approve a contract amendment to Fraser Construction for the construction portion of the Sun City Fire/EMS Station 39 (5,348,446).

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Tabernik, and Council Member McElynn. The motion passed 8:0.

10. Adjournment

Ratified: April 20, 2026